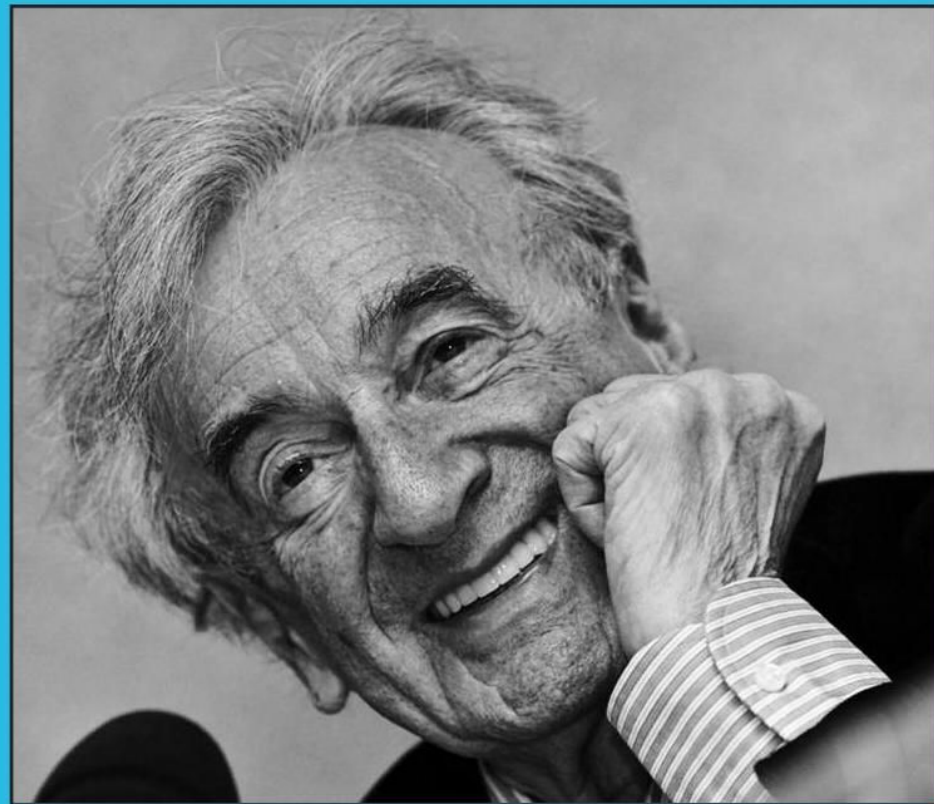


THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR



5777



THE BLUE CARD is a charitable organization aiding Holocaust survivors since 1934. It is dedicated to the support of European Jewish survivors and their descendants in this country, who still suffer from the aftereffects of Nazi persecution, are sick or emotionally unstable, have been unable to achieve economic independence, or have lost it through sickness or old age; in many cases the Holocaust has deprived them of family. The Blue Card's activities aren't duplicated by any other Jewish welfare agency. During the year 2015, The Blue Card made grants amounting to nearly \$2.8 million. This brings the grant total since The Blue Card's inception to over \$32 million.

THE BLUE CARD continues to receive four-star ratings from Charity Navigator, a distinction awarded to only four percent of all charities. The Blue Card is Better Business Bureau (BBB) accredited.

THE BLUE CARD mirrors the social conscience of our community. We hope it will be important to you, and that you will remember it in your last will. Your contribution is fully tax deductible.

THE BLUE CARD has been publishing this calendar for its friends and friends-to-be for more than 50 years in order to remind them, throughout the year, that there is an organization which is always ready to render assistance to our neediest.

PLEASE SEE the inside back cover of this calendar for more information about The Blue Card.

A copy of the most recent financial report may be obtained from The Blue Card, Inc., 171 Madison Ave. Suite 1405, New York, NY 10016.

Front cover: Elie Wiesel in Budapest, 2009.

Back cover: Elie Wiesel with President Obama at the White House.

THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

For 5777 (2016-2017 C.E.)

ITS THEME:
**REMEMBERING
ELIE WIESEL**

Published by

THE BLUE CARD, Inc.®

Serving needy Jewish Holocaust survivors since 1939

171 Madison Ave., Suite 1405

New York, NY 10016, USA

Tel.: (212) 239-2251

Fax: (212) 594-6881

Visit our Web site: www.BlueCardFund.org

E-mail: info@bluecardfund.org



5777

INTRODUCTION

This year's Blue Card Calendar honors the memory of Elie Wiesel, who passed away on July 2, 2016. He was one of the towering figures of our age, who wrote and spoke about injustice with enormous eloquence, and who gave voice to the voiceless.

Though he remains best known for his book *Night*, published in France in 1958 and in the U.S. in 1960, Wiesel was a prolific author and speaker who wrote some 60 books, published countless articles and gave innumerable talks, lectures and interviews. He also participated in documentary films.

Night was his seminal work, which gave rise to all the others. In Wiesel's words: "*Night*, my first narrative, was an autobiographical story, a kind of testimony of one witness speaking of his own life, his own death. All kinds of options were available: suicide, madness, killing, political action, hate, friendship. I note all of these options: faith, rejection of faith, blasphemy, atheism, denial, rejection of man, despair and in each book I explore one aspect. In *Dawn* I explore the political action; in *The Accident*, suicide; in *The Town Beyond the Wall*, madness; in *The Gates of the Forest*, faith and friendship; in *A Beggar in Jerusalem*, history, the return. All the stories are one story except that I build them in concentric circles. The center is the same and is in *Night*."

For all the despair, horror and questioning manifest in his work, Wiesel was ultimately able to lead a life of dignity, one that gave foundation to his public presence. He told Oprah Winfrey "What is abnormal is that I am normal. That I survived the Holocaust and went on to love beautiful girls, to talk, to write, to have toast and tea and live my life — that is what is abnormal."

The impact of Wiesel's writings was magnified by his presence as a public figure, involved in humanitarian concerns that affect the world. He spoke out against the genocides in Bosnia, Rwanda, Cambodia and Darfur. He condemned South African apartheid, the torture of prisoners

of conscience in Latin America, and in the U.S., the burning of black churches. He extended the lessons of the Holocaust to other places and times. In his Nobel acceptance speech, he said "As long as one dissident is in prison, our freedom will not be true. As long as one child is hungry, our lives will be filled with anguish and shame. What all these victims need above all is to know that they are not alone; that we are not forgetting them, that when their voices are stifled we shall lend them ours, that while their freedom depends on ours, the quality of our freedom depends on theirs."

His was a voice for caring and commitment: "The opposite of love is not hate, it's indifference. The opposite of art is not ugliness, it's indifference. The opposite of faith is not heresy, it's indifference. And the opposite of life is not death, it's indifference between life and death." He believed that every individual is important: "We must not see any person as an abstraction. Instead, we must see in every person a universe with its own secrets, with its own treasure, with its own sources of anguish, and with some measure of triumph."

Joseph Berger of the *New York Times* wrote in Elie Wiesel's obituary: "While many of his books were nominally about topics like Soviet Jews or Hasidic masters, they all dealt with profound questions resonating out of the Holocaust: What is the sense of living in a universe that tolerates unimaginable cruelty? How could the world have been mute? How can one go on believing? Mr. Wiesel asked the questions in spare prose and without raising his voice; he rarely offered answers."

This year's edition was edited by Ralph Hammelbacher. Hella Hammelbacher created the original design, which was ably realized by Jacqueline Enrique.



Eliezer Wiesel, who eventually chose to be called "Elie," was born in the town of Sighet, in Transylvania, in 1928. In Wiesel's words: "Sighet, the region's capital... wasn't much of a capital. It did, however, have a penchant for changing — its name, its nationality, and thus its allegiance. When my father was born, it was a proud part of the Austro-Hungarian

Empire and called itself Maramarossziget. When I first saw the light of day, it proudly bore the name of Sighetul Marmatiei and belonged to the Kingdom of Greater Romania. When I left it, it was Maramarossziget again, a Hungarian city of noisy patriotism." It is today part of Romania, but claimed by Hungary.



Elie Wiesel at age 15.

Elie Wiesel was a very studious young man, spending his days in religious studies, consumed by studies of the Talmud and with a strong desire to study the Kabbalah. His mother, Sarah, was deeply spiritual, and his maternal grandfather, Dodye Feig, a farmer who was a great religious storyteller, had a deep influence on Elie's religious studies. Elie's father, Shlomo, owned a store, and though observant, also had a practical bent. Shlomo insisted that Elie learn modern Hebrew, so that he could read the work of contemporary writers, and that Elie devote a portion of his studies to secular affairs.

Elie had two older sisters, Beatrice and Hilda, and a younger sister, Tzipora.

Av - Elul 5776						
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
				1	2	3
4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Elul 1	Labor Day					
11	12	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30	

Elul 5776 - Tishri 5777						
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Erev Rosh Hashana	Tishri 1 5777 Rosh Hashana	Rosh Hashana Second Day				
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
	Columbus Day	Erev Yom Kippur	Yom Kippur			
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
	Succoth 1st Day	Succoth 2nd Day				
23 Hashana Rabba	24 Shmini Atzeret	25	26	27	28	29
30	31 Simchat Torah					



One of the synagogues at Sighet.

In 1940, Sighet came under Hungarian control, a development initially welcomed by the town's Jews, who felt the Hungarians were more liberal and tolerant. But the following years, all non-Hungarian Jews were deported, including Elie's mentor Moishe the Beadle — who survived by pretending to be dead after being wounded in the leg. From *Night*: "And then, one day all the foreign Jews were

expelled from Sighet. And Moishe the Beadle was a foreigner. Crammed into cattle cars by the Hungarian police, they cried silently. Standing on the station platform, we too were crying. The train disappeared over the horizon; all that was left was thick, dirty smoke." Across the border, in Ukraine, approximately 23,600 Jews were murdered on August 27 and 28, 1941 — believed to be the first large-scale massacre by the Nazis.

Tishri - Heshvan 5777						NOVEMBER 2016
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
		1	2 Heshvan 1	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Daylight Time Ends					Veteran's Day	
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26
				Thanksgiving		
27	28	29	30			



A photo of Tzipora Wiesel that Elie Wiesel carried with him all his life.

Life for Sighet's Jews continued in more or less normal fashion for several years, but that abruptly came to an end in April 1944. In rapid succession, Jewish leaders were arrested, Jews were forbidden to leave their homes, they were required to relinquish their possessions and to wear a yellow star, and then required to move into one of the town's two ghettos. Because the Wiesels' home was already in one of the ghettos, they were able to remain. In May, Jews including the Wiesels were loaded into cattle cars and deported to Auschwitz II (Birkenau). When they arrived, women and men were separated into two lines, men to the left and women to the right. Elie Wiesel never saw his mother or his youngest sister, Tzipora, again.

Kislev - Tevet 5777						DECEMBER 2016
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
				1 Kislev 1	2	3
4	5	6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20	21	22	23	24
						Hanukkah First Candle
25	26	27	28	29	30	31
Christmas Day					Tevet 1	Hanukkah Eighth Candle New Year's Eve



The barracks at Buchenwald. The arrow points to Elie Wiesel.

Elie Wiesel and his father were moved to Auschwitz I and then to the Buna labor camp. They survived the hangings, hunger, beatings, torture, illness and inhumanity, a "selection," and the constant death around them. In mid-January, Elie Wiesel's foot became swollen and was operated on by a Jewish doctor. Three days later, as the Russians were closing in on Buna, Elie, his father and thousands more were evacuated, forced to run and march some fifty miles to the Gleiwitz concentration camp. After three days, they

were taken by train to Buchenwald. One hundred prisoners were put on the cattle car and twelve, including Elie and his father, survived to get off the train at Buchenwald. Malnourished and suffering from dysentery, Shlomo Wiesel died soon afterward.

Tevet - Shevat 5777						JANUARY 2017
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
New Year's Day						
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
	Martin Luther King Jr. Day					
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
						Shevat 1
29	30	31				



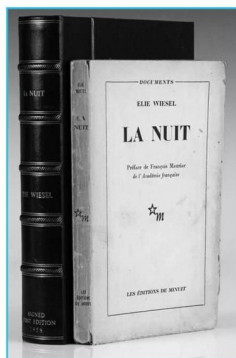
Displaced Jewish youth at Ambloy, France, 1945. The arrow points to Elie Wiesel.

Wiesel began learning French and attended high school in Normandy. In 1948, he began four years of study in Paris at the Sorbonne, and later became Paris correspondent for the Israeli newspaper *Yediot Ahronoth*.

In 1954, he met with the French theologian François Mauriac, who spoke continuously of the suffering of Jesus. Unable to contain himself, Wiesel said "...ten years ago, not very far from here, I knew Jewish children every one of whom suffered a thousand times more, six million times more, than Christ on the cross. And we don't speak about them." Wiesel got up and left, but Mauriac followed him to the elevator, asked Wiesel about his experiences and told him, "I think that you are wrong not to speak.... Listen to the old man that I am: one must speak out." As a result, Wiesel began work on what became *Night*.

On April 11, 1945, American troops liberated Buchenwald. Elie Wiesel ended up in France — there was no longer a Jewish population in Sighet, and the British did not allow him to emigrate to Palestine. (Later, after the establishment of the state of Israel, he was also refused immigration on medical grounds.) His sister Hilda saw him in a published photo of a group of Jewish children, and they were subsequently reunited. He also found his oldest sister, Beatrice.

Shevat - Adar 5777						FEBRUARY 2017
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
			1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
						Tu B'Shevat
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Lincoln's Birthday		Valentine's Day				
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
	Presidents Day		Washington's Birthday			
26	27	28				
	Adar 1					

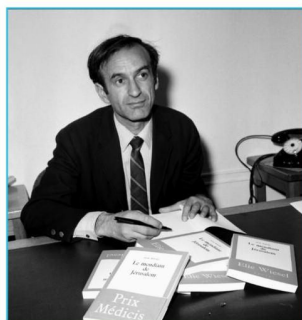


Elie Wiesel wrote what later became *Night* in Yiddish, with a title that translates as *And the World Remained Silent*. It ran to some 245 pages (greatly cut from the original manuscript), and was published to little notice in 1956 in Argentina. Two years later, Wiesel pared it down further, translated it into French and published it as *La Nuit*, with a preface by Mauriac. In 1960, it was translated from French into English and published as *Night*, running just over 100 pages. Initial sales were minuscule, but the book gradually gained interest among reviewers and literary figures.

As we wrote in last year's Blue Card calendar, *Night* is surely one of the most powerful and unsparing books ever written. It is simultaneously a remembrance, a novel and a book of philosophy. It describes the experience of the ghetto, deportation, the unspeakable concentration camps, the death march and liberation. But its larger themes are questions of faith in God and faith in human relationships, including the narrator's own conflicted feelings about his father.

One of the most influential books about the Holocaust, *Night* has been read and discussed by millions. It is not entirely without controversy, as scholars have debated how much is memoir and how much was made up. Wiesel always maintained that it was entirely memoir.

Adar - Nisan 5777						MARCH 2017
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
			1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
						Erev Purim
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Purim Daylight Time Begins						
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	29	30	31	
		Nisan 1				



Elie Wiesel in 1969.

In 1955, Wiesel moved to New York City, on assignment as foreign correspondent for *Yediot Ahronoth*. He was still stateless and ended up becoming a U.S. permanent resident, and, in 1963, a citizen. He was hit by a taxi while crossing a city street in July, 1956, and during his lengthy recuperation decided to devote more of his time to writing. What followed was a profusion of work. He wrote about 60 books in all, in French and English.

He later said, "The language I think in depends on the topic and the period. If it's about my childhood, I think in Yiddish, because that was my language. If it's about America, I think in English, but if it's about literature or philosophy, it goes back to French."

He met and in 1969 married Marion Rose, an Austrian Holocaust survivor. She also became his partner in his work, co-founding the Elie Wiesel Foundation for Humanity and translating many of his books, notably a new version of *Night* in 2006. In 1972 they had a son, Shlomo Elisha (named after Elie Wiesel's father, and known today as Elisha); Marion Wiesel also had a daughter, Jennifer, from a previous marriage.

Nisan - Iyar 5777						APRIL 2017
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
	Erev Passover	Passover 1st Day				
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
		Passover 8th Day				
Easter Sunday	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	Yom Hashoah			Iyar 1		



In 1976, Wiesel began teaching at Boston University, where he maintained a professional relationship for the rest of his life. In 1990, the university acquired Wiesel's archives, consisting of his notebooks, manuscripts, letters and many other artifacts. The Elie Wiesel Center for Jewish Studies at the university, named in his honor, offers interdisciplinary undergraduate and graduate programs. Wiesel for decades gave an annual fall lecture series called "Three Encounters with Elie Wiesel," discussing the lives and significance of scholars and those in the Bible. Many of these talks are archived at <http://bit.ly/three-encounters>.

Iyar - Sivan 5777						
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
	1	2 Israel Independence Day	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12	13
14 Lag B'Omer Mother's Day	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26 Sivan 1	27
28	29 Memorial Day	30 Erev Shavuot	31 Shavuot 1st Day			



Accepting the Nobel Peace Prize. From left: Marion Wiesel, Elisha Wiesel, Elie Wiesel, Nobel Peace Prize Committee Chairman Egil Aarvik.

In 1986, Elie Wiesel was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize. The Norwegian Nobel Committee said that "Elie Wiesel has emerged as one of the most important spiritual leaders and guides in an age when violence, repression and racism continue to characterize the world." In his acceptance speech, Wiesel said: "We must take sides, for neutrality helps the oppressor, never the victim. Silence encourages the tormentor, never the

tormented. Sometimes we must interfere. When human lives are endangered, when human dignity is in jeopardy, national borders and sensitivities become irrelevant. Wherever men or women are persecuted because of their race, religion, or political views, that place must — at that moment — become the center of the universe."

The acceptance speech may be seen at <http://bit.ly/wiesel-nobel>.

Sivan - Tammuz 5777						
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
				1	2	3
4	5	6	7	8	9	10
11	12	13	14	15	16	17
18	19	20	21	22	23	24
25 Father's Day Tammuz 1	26	27	28	29	30	



An Israeli center for education for Ethiopian-Israeli Jews.

In 1986, the same year he received the Nobel Peace Prize, Elie Wiesel, with his wife, Marion, established the Elie Wiesel Foundation for Humanity. The foundation's mission is "to combat indifference, intolerance and injustice through international dialogue and youth-focused programs that promote acceptance, understanding and equality." Among other activities, the foundation has held a series of international conferences focusing on peace, education, health, the environment and terrorism. It sponsors an annual ethics essay contest in the U.S., where college

students analyze ethical issues. In Israel, the foundation offers educational programs for nearly 1,000 Ethiopian-Israeli children.

In 2008, the foundation lost more than \$15 million in investments as a result of Bernard Madoff's Ponzi scheme. Part of this was made up with an influx of small donations which followed the news of the loss. Elie and Marion Wiesel also lost most of their life savings.

Tammuz - Av 5777						
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
						1
2	3	4 Independence Day	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24 Av 1	25	26	27	28	29
30	31					



Dedicating the United States Holocaust Memorial Museum in 1993, with Harvey Meyerhoff, Chairperson of the United States Holocaust Memorial Council, and President Bill Clinton.

As the years passed, Elie Wiesel became more and more a public voice for remembering the Holocaust and for speaking out against contemporary injustices. He played a vital role in establishing the United States Holocaust Memorial Museum in Washington, serving as chairman of the commission that raised funds for the museum. The museum has gone on to become one of the world's most important organizations for research into and remembrance of the Holocaust.

Sara J. Bloomfield, the museum's director, said "But it was Elie's singular voice — a voice whose

moral clarity resonated with millions from all walks of life — that was his hallmark. He also boldly envisioned the museum as a voice. He called it a "living memorial." For him, memory was sacred but it also had to have a purpose. He saw the museum as a unique moral platform that would serve as an antidote to one of the world's gravest problems — indifference."

Av - Elul 5777						
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
		1 Tisha B'Av	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23 Elul 1	24	25	26
27	28	29	30	31		

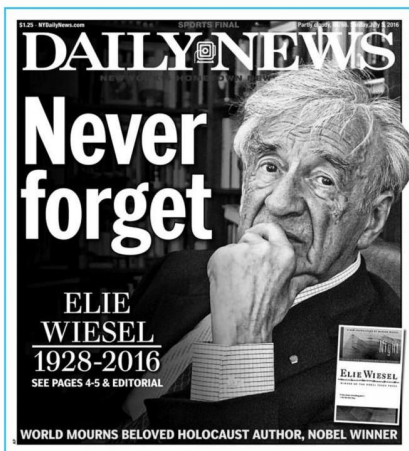


Michael Douglas presenting the award to Elie Wiesel.

On November 16, 2015, The Blue Card presented Elie Wiesel with the Richard C. Holbrooke Award for Social Justice. The award was given at The Blue Card's annual benefit gala, held at the New York Public Library — that year, celebrating the organization's 81st year aiding Holocaust survivors. In his speech, Elie Wiesel said, "There is enough poverty to make us wonder, what are we doing about it. ...enough despair in the world ...to question our real commitment to improve the human condition

everywhere, not only in our own town. We have learned that in life, as God has willed it, human conditions are limitless in both good and in bad."

Elul 5777 - Tishri 5778						
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
					1	2
3	4 Labor Day	5	6	7	8	9
10	11	12	13	14	15	16
17	18	19	20 Erev Rosh Hashana	21 Tishri 1 5778 Rosh Hashana	22 Rosh Hashana Second Day	23
24	25	26	27	28	29 Erev Yom Kippur	30 Yom Kippur



Elie Wiesel died at home in New York on July 2, 2016, and his funeral at the Orthodox Fifth Avenue Synagogue in Manhattan took place a day later. Relatives and friends of long standing talked about the meaning of his life, his wit, his close family ties, and also his lasting impact. The *New York Times* quoted his friend Rabbi Shmuley Boteach: "What went through my mind the entire time was that the six million of the Holocaust were never granted the dignity of a burial; their ashes were merely scattered. Here we were with the privilege of burying the Holocaust's greatest witness."

Tishri - Heshvan 5778						
SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
1	2	3	4 Erev Succoth	5 Succoth 1st Day	6 Succoth 2nd Day	7
8	9 Columbus Day	10	11 Hoshana Rabba	12 Shemini Atzeret	13 Simchat Torah	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21 Heshvan 1
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				



Established in Germany in 1934, The Blue Card's sole purpose was to provide financial assistance to Jews fleeing from that country's growing persecution. It was re-established in the United States in 1939, to continue aiding refugees escaping from the Nazi horror. Today, it is the only organization in the United States whose sole mission is to aid needy Holocaust survivors by providing cash assistance.

Description of Our Programs

The Blue Card provides assistance through the following core programs:

- **Emergency Cash Assistance Program:** provides for survivors' most immediate needs by helping with the cost of medicine, rent, homeware, food and other essentials. The Holocaust Survivor Emergency Cash Assistance Program is funded by the Claims Conference on Jewish Material Claims Against Germany.
- **Dental Program:** named after Curt C. and Elsie Silberman, provides much needed funding toward dental care, especially in a time of federal budget cuts.
- **Stipend Program:** supports the most poverty-stricken survivors with monthly checks.
- **Jewish Holiday Program:** provides financial assistance for the High Holidays, Hanukkah and Passover, giving survivors the financial means to have a happier holiday season.
- **Summer Vacation Program:** named after Adolph and Lotte Rosenberg, offers a free summer vacation program to needy survivors in the New York area. Survivors are provided with handicapped-accessible accommodations, transportation, scheduled meals, and a well-planned itinerary, making the program structured, safe and group-oriented.
- **The Telephone Emergency Response Program:** named after Jakob Mogilnik, provides an emergency response system to Holocaust survivors who do not have the financial resources for installation, service and maintenance. The operator answers in Yiddish, German, Russian, Hungarian or other, and then follows up should there be an emergency.
- **Mazel Tov Birthday Program:** provides survivors with a check and a card on their birthday. Receiving a birthday card means a great deal to survivors who lost their entire families during the war.
- **Vitamins Program:** provides Holocaust survivors with multivitamins, minerals and supplements, and liquid meals.
- **Bring a Smile Program:** named after Sonia and Max Lonstein, provides additional support for terminally ill Holocaust survivors. The program essentially grants survivors their final wish.

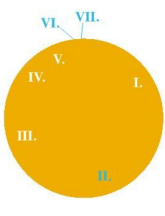
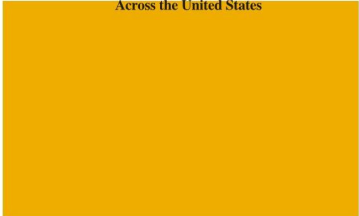
- **The Sigi B. Wilzig Fighting Cancer Together Program:** offers aid to Holocaust survivors battling cancer. Assistance is available for transportation to appointments, medical co-pays, nutrition and emotional support.
- **The Blue Card-Lissner Hospital Visitation Program:** offers volunteer visits to hospitalized Holocaust survivors who need guidance and emotional support.
- **The Nutritional Guidance Program:** named after Rita Berkowitz, provides monthly food stipends and nutritional supplements. It also educates participants on proper nutrition.

In 2015, The Blue Card distributed \$2,800,328 to destitute Holocaust survivors in the United States; below is the breakdown of that number.

I.	Homework	\$907,154
II.	Emergency Cash Assistance	\$727,472
III.	Monthly Assistance	\$644,215 *
IV.	Telephone Emergency Response	\$266,415
V.	Jewish Holidays	\$167,122
VI.	Birthday Program	\$58,085
VII.	Summer Retreat	\$29,865
Total		\$2,800,328

*Includes: Fighting Cancer Together Program, Vitamin Program, Nutritional Guidance Program.

The Blue Card's Clients
Across the United States



THE BLUE CARD CALENDAR

5777

